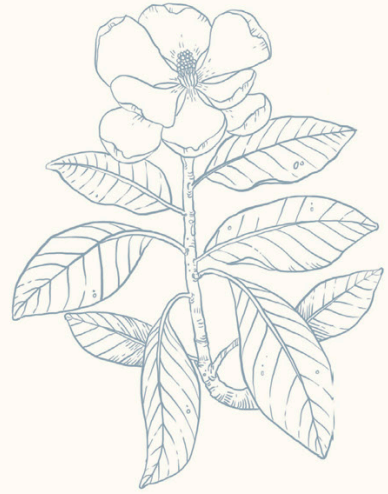
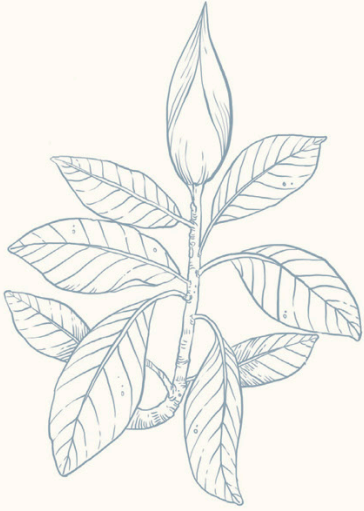


*Magnolias are named after French scientist  
Pierre Magnol, who worked out how some  
plants are related to each other.*

# Magnolia



**M**agnolias produced some of the first ever flowers on Earth. These ancient trees have big blooms that attract beetles. The beetles are useful pollinators, but these heavy insects are clumsy, so the magnolia's petals have to be thick and tough.

Some magnolias lose their leaves in autumn. Their flower buds have a furry jacket to keep them warm over winter. In spring, they burst into flower before their foliage grows back. Other magnolias are green all year round. Southern magnolias are evergreen trees with large, white flowers that can be 30 cm (12 in) wide! The fuzzy, alien-looking fruit they grow contain bright-red seeds, which are a treat for birds and squirrels.